Use ChatGPT to See What Running Your Father's Care Really Takes

Four prompts to list what your care consultant has been handling, mark which tasks your family has actually done rather than watched, spot where you'd want help, and turn it into a one-page starting list for the handoff conversation.

Where you are

Your care consultant has been coordinating your father's care since he moved, and she has said the time is coming for the family to take more of it on. You've sat in the meetings, but you couldn't write down what she actually does in a week.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can name the recurring tasks behind your father's care, say which ones someone in the family has done rather than watched, and bring an honest list of where you'd want help to the handoff conversation.

A one-page handoff starting list with four headings: Tasks we've seen, Tasks we've done ourselves, Tasks we'd want help with, and Questions for the handoff conversation.

Before you start

- Your notes or emails from recent care meetings, even partial ones.
- A sense of who in the family shows up for your father's care and what each person tends to do.
- The current care plan or any schedule you were given. You don't need all of it to begin.

PROMPT 1

Write down what has been happening each week

WHY THIS MATTERS

When someone else coordinates well, the work disappears. You remember the big meetings and forget the twenty phone calls that made them go smoothly.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Whatever you have from recent months: meeting notes, emails, texts, and your own memory.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My father has had a care consultant coordinating his care for the past several months, and my family is going to take over more of it. Here is what I remember and what I have in notes, emails,

and texts about what she has been doing:

[PASTE YOUR NOTES]

Pull out every recurring task you can find and put it in a table with three columns: the task, how often it seems to happen, and who did it as far as I can tell. Add a row for anything I mention that happened once and might happen again. Mark any task where I don't know who handled it with a question mark instead of guessing.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Tasks you had forgotten about, and question marks where nobody knows who has been doing the work.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Show the table to another family member and ask what they would add.

PROMPT 2

Separate what you've done from what you've watched

WHY THIS MATTERS

Sitting in a care meeting is not the same as running one. Families often believe they know a task because they have seen it done many times.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The table from the first prompt and an honest answer for each row.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here is a table of the tasks involved in coordinating my father's care:

[PASTE THE TABLE FROM PROMPT 1]

For each task, I'm going to tell you which of these is true for my family: someone has done it themselves from start to finish, someone has helped with part of it, or we have only watched someone else do it. Here are my answers:

[PASTE YOUR ANSWERS]

Rebuild the table with a fourth column that shows this, using the words DONE IT, HELPED, or WATCHED. Then list the WATCHED tasks separately, with one line each on what a first practice run

> might look like. Do not tell me whether we are ready to take any of these on. That is a conversation for us and our consultant.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How many tasks fall under WATCHED, a number that is usually bigger than families expect and is nothing to be embarrassed about.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Pick one WATCHED task and ask your care consultant if you can do it yourselves next time while she is still there.

PROMPT 3

Spot where you would want help

WHY THIS MATTERS

The pressure in a handoff is to say yes to everything. A family that can point to the tasks it is unsure about is in a stronger position than one that nods along.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The table from the second prompt.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is where my family stands on the tasks involved in my father's care:
>
> [PASTE THE TABLE FROM PROMPT 2]
>
> Help me see where we would want help, without deciding for us. Sort the tasks into three lists: TASKS WE COULD LEARN WITH SOME PRACTICE, TASKS WE WOULD WANT SOMEONE ELSE TO KEEP DOING FOR NOW, and NOT SURE YET. Base the sorting only on what I've written, and say which sentence of mine led you to each placement so I can disagree. Then list any task where only one person in the family is named, with no one to step in if that person is sick or away.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Tasks that rest on one person, and the NOT SURE list, which is where the handoff conversation should spend its time.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the person named on each single-person task whether they agree they're the one.

PROMPT 4

Put it on one page for the handoff conversation

WHY THIS MATTERS

Your care consultant can only help with what she can see. One page that shows where the family stands lets her spend the meeting on the real questions instead of reconstructing them.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've gathered about taking on more of my father's care coordination:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Turn it into one page with four headings: TASKS WE'VE SEEN, TASKS WE'VE DONE OURSELVES, TASKS WE'D WANT HELP WITH, and QUESTIONS FOR THE HANDOFF CONVERSATION. Under the last heading, write the questions my family should ask our care consultant, including which tasks she thinks should stay with a professional and what she would want to see us do before anything changes hands. Keep it to plain sentences. Do not write a playbook, do not state whether we are ready, and do not suggest a date for the handoff.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page that shows where the family stands without pretending the handoff is settled.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Bring the page to your next meeting with your care consultant and let her add to it.

Start the handoff from one file.

A handoff goes better when the whole picture of your father's situation sits in one place. The care interview organizes it area by area into a Family Care Profile, the file the family and your care consultant can both work from, whatever the handoff turns out to look like.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›